

Friday, 19 June 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Partly cloudy

30° 18°

BIRMINGHAM

Overcast

25° 16°

MANCHESTER

Drizzle

24° 18°

GLASGOW

Rain

17° 15°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1 A teacher who murdered his adopted baby son has been given a whole life prison sentence, after the court heard details of horrific abuse.**

Preston Davey died after months of sexual and physical abuse at the hands of Jamie Varley. This harrowing case has shocked the nation, highlighting the vulnerability of children.

CRIME · UK

- 2 The Bank of England has held interest rates steady, warning that high energy prices are still impacting the economy.**

This decision comes after the Bank last cut rates in December, but ongoing upheaval in the Middle East has stalled any further reductions. It means borrowing costs will remain high for now.

ECONOMY · UK

- 3 Two men have been jailed for spying for Chinese intelligence here in the UK, in a significant national security case.**

One of the individuals was a Border Force official, who used his access to Home Office data to gather information on Chinese dissidents. This case raises serious concerns about foreign espionage.

NATIONAL SECURITY · UK

- 4 A long-awaited inquiry has found that vulnerable patients' lives were made 'miserable' by abuse at Muckamore Abbey Hospital.**

The final report is expected to reveal the full extent of the mistreatment of patients at the facility. It's a deeply troubling story that will prompt calls for change.

HEALTH · UK

- 5 There's positive health news today: young women now have a 'close to zero' risk of cervical cancer death after receiving the HPV jab.**

A new study reveals that hundreds of lives have been saved since school-age girls were offered the HPV jab back in 2008. It's a testament to the success of the vaccination programme.

HEALTH · UK

What's coming up

1 **London's new Museum of London site at Smithfield is set to open its doors in November, promising a fantastic new cultural destination.**

The historic building will become home to some incredible exhibits, including Banksy's piranhas and the UK's oldest hand-written document. It sounds like a must-visit for history and art lovers.

ON AIR – Are you excited about the new London Museum? What kind of exhibits are you hoping to see?

CULTURE · AUTUMN

2 **The fifth instalment of the beloved animated franchise, Toy Story 5, has divided critics, but most are praising its 'cautionary' message about technology.**

Tom Hanks, Tim Allen, and Joan Cusack all return to voice their iconic characters. It sounds like the film is tackling some timely themes while still delivering that classic Toy Story magic.

ON AIR – Are you looking forward to Toy Story 5? What's your favourite Toy Story film?

FILM · COMING SOON

3 **Behind the scenes of the new James Bond video game, we're hearing how music is bringing the blockbuster to life.**

The score for the game has been recorded, promising an immersive experience for fans. It's always fascinating to hear how much effort goes into the soundtrack of these big productions.

ON AIR – Are you a fan of James Bond video games? What's your favourite Bond theme tune?

GAMING · COMING SOON

4 **Singer-songwriter Myles Smith has revealed his debut album is inspired by five years of therapy notes and his personal experiences.**

His first collection delves into the experiences that shaped him before he found fame. It sounds like it's going to be a very honest and personal record.

ON AIR – Do you like artists who share their personal stories in their music? What's your favourite debut album?

MUSIC · NEW RELEASE

5 **Harry Styles has been reminiscing about his X Factor audition as he kicked off his Wembley residency.**

The pop superstar's audition took place near Wembley Stadium back in 2010. It's a lovely full-circle moment for him, looking back at where it all began.

ON AIR – Do you remember Harry Styles' X Factor audition? What's your favourite Harry Styles song?

MUSIC · THIS WEEK

On the schedule

1 **England have made a winning start to their World Cup 2026 campaign, beating Croatia 4-2 in a thrilling match in Dallas!**

It was an exciting opening game, with England showing some strong attacking football. A great way to kick off their tournament hopes.

ON AIR – What did you make of England's performance against Croatia? Are you feeling confident for the rest of the tournament?

FOOTBALL · THIS WEEK

2 **While England's attack looked exciting against Croatia, tactical analysis suggests they might need to tighten up defensively.**

They produced some great attacking football, but did look a little shaky at the back at times. Something for the team to work on as the tournament progresses.

ON AIR – Do you agree England need to improve their defence? What changes would you make?

FOOTBALL · THIS WEEK

3 **England has lost their first wicket in the second Test against New Zealand, with Ben Duckett run out for 36 at The Oval.**

New Zealand made the breakthrough on day two, leaving England 45-1 in their first innings. It's an important moment in the match for both sides.

ON AIR – Are you following the England vs New Zealand Test match? What do you think of England's start?

CRICKET · THIS WEEK

4 **Ben Stokes is making his return to action for Durham, after being named in their squad for the County Championship match against Northamptonshire.**

The dropped England captain will be playing for his county side, a chance for him to get back into form. It'll be interesting to see how he performs.

ON AIR – Are you pleased to see Ben Stokes back playing for Durham? Do you think he'll be back in the England squad soon?

CRICKET · THIS WEEK

5 **Huge news for Exeter Chiefs fans: star wing Immanuel Feyi-Waboso has declared himself fit for Saturday's Premiership final!**

This is a massive boost for Exeter as they prepare to face Northampton in the final. His return could be a game-changer for the team.

ON AIR – Are you an Exeter Chiefs fan? Who do you think will win the Premiership final?

RUGBY · THIS WEEK

Quick hits

- 1 A new trend sees city dwellers embracing 'balcony biodiversity' by transforming small outdoor spaces into thriving mini-ecosystems.**
It's all about attracting local wildlife, from busy bees to chirping birds, using carefully selected plants and clever design. Imagine a little slice of nature, right outside your flat!
- 2 Research suggests that the simple act of 'doodling' during meetings can actually boost memory and concentration.**
Far from being a sign of distraction, those little sketches and scribbles might just be helping your brain stay engaged and process information more effectively. So, doodle away!
- 3 The popularity of 'comfort reading nooks' is growing, as people dedicate small, cosy corners of their homes to pure relaxation with a good book.**
Think soft blankets, warm lighting, and a pile of unread novels. It's the perfect antidote to a busy day, offering a tranquil escape without leaving the house.
- 4 Experts are noting a rise in 'vintage board game clubs', bringing classic table-top fun back into fashion.**
Forget screens; it's all about friendly competition, strategic thinking, and a good old-fashioned chat over games like Cluedo or Monopoly. A lovely way to connect.
- 5 A study reveals that regularly looking at 'green spaces' – even just through a window – can significantly lower stress levels.**
It seems a daily dose of nature, however small, is brilliant for our well-being. Perhaps it's time to rearrange the furniture to get a better view!
- 6 The trend for 'DIY fermented foods' is bubbling up, with more people trying their hand at making kimchi, kombucha, and sourdough.**
It's a tasty way to get creative in the kitchen and enjoy delicious, gut-friendly treats. Plus, there's something very satisfying about making things from scratch!
- 7 New research highlights the joy and mental benefits of 'puzzle solving', from jigsaws to crosswords.**
Engaging in puzzles offers a wonderful mental workout, improving problem-solving skills and providing a sense of accomplishment. A perfect pastime for a quiet evening.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 65% of us admit to secretly 'rearranging' what in our kitchen cupboards, even if it's not strictly necessary?

ANSWER: THE SPICE RACK, OF COURSE! WE ALL HAVE OUR PREFERRED ORDER, DON'T WE?

Q Our survey said that over 50% of us admit to having a specific 'lucky' item of clothing or accessory we wear for important occasions. What is it?

ANSWER: A PARTICULAR PAIR OF SOCKS, APPARENTLY! WHO KNEW HOSIERY HELD SUCH POWER?

TALK TOPIC

- **You know how sometimes you find a new 'local shop' or business that just instantly becomes your go-to for something specific?**
What's that one local place you absolutely couldn't do without, and why is it so brilliant? Give us a call and tell us your local hero!

- **We all have those little 'soundtrack moments' in life, don't we? Where a particular piece of music just perfectly fits the moment you're in.**
What was the last song you heard that perfectly matched your mood or what you were doing? Let us know what track provided the soundtrack to your day!

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Space.** There are more trees on Earth than stars in the Milky Way galaxy. Scientists estimate there are around 3 trillion trees and 100-400 billion stars.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Astronauts grow several centimetres taller in space because there's no gravity pushing down on their spines, but they shrink back to normal upon returning to Earth.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£6.46 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£6.46 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- A group of owls is called a parliament.
- Honey never spoils; archaeologists have found pots of honey in ancient Egyptian tombs that are still edible.
- The shortest war in history was between Britain and Zanzibar on August 27, 1896, lasting only 38 to 45 minutes.
- The 'king' in a deck of cards is the only one without a moustache.
- The Great Barrier Reef is the largest living structure on Earth and can be seen from outer space.
- It is impossible for most people to lick their own elbow.
- Octopuses have three hearts: two pump blood through the gills, and one circulates it to the rest of the body.
- Mount Everest grows by about 4 millimetres every year due to geological activity.

On this day

Day 170 of the year, 195 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Deodatus (or Didier) of Nevers (or of Jointures); Christian feast day: Gervasius and Protasius (Catholic Church); Christian feast day: Hildegrim of Châlons; Christian feast day: Juliana Falconieri. Star sign Gemini, birthstone Pearl.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1928 — Nancy Marchand, American actress (died 2000)
- 1975 — Hugh Dancy, English actor and model
- 1946 — Jimmy Greenhoff, English footballer and manager
- 1984 — Paul Dano, American actor
- 1992 — Keaton Jennings, South African-English cricketer
- 1978 — Zoe Saldaña, American actress
- 1970 — Brian Welch, American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1965 — Sadie Frost, English actress and producer

THE DAY TODAY

- 1987 — Aeroflot Flight N-528 crashes at Berdiansk Airport in present-day Ukraine, killing eight people.
- 1945 — The Smoke Tragedy left 355 workers dead in the underground copper mine of El Teniente, Chile.
- 1964 — The Civil Rights Act of 1964 is approved after surviving an 83-day filibuster in the United States Senate.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1961 — Kuwait declares independence from the United Kingdom.
- 2012 — WikiLeaks founder Julian Assange requests asylum in London's Ecuadorian Embassy for fear of extradition to the US after publication of previously classified documents including footage of civilian killings by the US army; he will remain there until 2019.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1945 — The Smoke Tragedy left 355 workers dead in the underground copper mine of El Teniente, Chile.
- 1982 — The People's Armed Police is de facto founded; It is officially established 10 months later on April 5, 1983

- 1964 — The Civil Rights Act of 1964 is approved after surviving an 83-day filibuster in the United States Senate.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 171 of the year, 194 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Adalbert of Magdeburg; Christian feast day: Blessed Dermot O'Hurley; Christian feast day: Florentina; Christian feast day: John of Matera. Star sign Gemini, birthstone Pearl.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1966 — Boaz Yakin, American director, producer, and screenwriter
- 1947 — Dolores "LaLa" Brooks, American pop singer
- 1967 — Dan Tyminski, American singer-songwriter
- 1952 — John Goodman, American actor
- 1940 — John Mahoney, English-born American actor (died 2018)
- 1954 — Michael Anthony, American musician
- 1954 — Allan Lamb, South African-English cricketer and sportscaster
- 1978 — Quinton Jackson, American mixed martial artist and actor

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1956 — A Venezuelan Super-Constellation crashes in the Atlantic Ocean off Asbury Park, New Jersey, killing 74 people.
- 1948 — The Deutsche Mark is introduced in Western Allied-occupied Germany. The Soviet Military Administration in Germany responded by imposing the Berlin Blockade four days later.
- 1996 — Space Shuttle Columbia launches on STS-78 to conduct life science and microgravity research aboard the Spacelab module.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1979 — ABC News correspondent Bill Stewart is shot dead by a Nicaraguan National Guard soldier under the regime of Anastasio Somoza Debayle during the Nicaraguan Revolution. The murder is caught on tape and sparks an international outcry against the regime.
- 1994 — The 1994 Imam Reza shrine bomb explosion in Iran leaves at least 25 dead and 70 to 300 injured.

Coming to cinemas

JUNE 2026	
FRI 19	Pixar's Toy Story 5
FRI 26	Supergirl: Woman of Tomorrow (+ IMAX); A Private Life

JULY 2026	
WED 1	Minions & Monsters
FRI 3	Shiver; Young Washington
FRI 10	Moana (live action); Evil Dead Burn
FRI 17	Christopher Nolan's The Odyssey (+ IMAX); Cut Off
FRI 24	Heads of State; Untitled DCU
FRI 31	Spider-Man: Brand New Day

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

JUNE 2026		JULY 2026	
11 JUN – 19 JUL	FIFA World Cup (USA / Canada / Mexico)	4–26 JUL	Tour de France (Cycling)
12 JUN – 5 JUL	ICC Women's T20 World Cup (England & Wales)	SUN 5	British Grand Prix, Silverstone
18–21 JUN	U.S. Open (Golf)	16–19 JUL	The Open Championship (Golf)
29 JUN – 12 JUL	Wimbledon	18–26 JUL	World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool
		23 JUL – 2 AUG	Commonwealth Games, Glasgow
		AUGUST 2026	
		W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
		SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
		22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)